margothonecker-45705598.bild.html

26. Ibid

27. Schabowski, p.111

28. The document dated January 1971 is confirmed by the fact that a copy of it was confiscated on December 7, 1989 by the East Berlin public prosecutor's office in Willi Stoph's house, where it had been kept in a five-fold sealed envelope. The thirteen signatories were Hermann Axen, Gerhard Grüneberg, Kurt Hager, Erich Honecker, Horst Sindermann, Willi Stoph, Paul Verner, Erich Mückenberger, Herbert Warnke, Werner Jarowinsky, Werner Lamberz, Günther Kleiber and economic reformer Günter Mittag who thought Ulbricht's economic policy 'Was no longer responsible and had become megalomaniac' But Honecker and his colleagues were evidently certain that their request would be taken seriously and supported in Moscow. Honecker had also tried – but in vain – to get a signature from the terminally ill Hermann Materil, who was receiving artificial ventilation in the government hospital. Unlike some of his associates, Politburo member Alfred Neumann, an astute politician, clearly grasped the significance of this moment and refused to sign the letter, instead accusing Honecker of 'letting off steam' and 'creating mood against Walter'. Friedrich Ebert, Georg Ewald, Walter Halbritter, Margarete Müller and Albert Norden also refused to sign.

Cometh the Hour

1. Allgemeiner Deutscher Nachrichtendienst. 3 May 1971

2. ADN. 3 May 1971

3. Brezhnev telegram to Honecker, 3 May 1971

4. ADN. 4 May 1971